

HDD Sheriff 2000

New Sherrif in town

HDD Sheriff 2000 is a hardware-based solution for protecting the data on your hard drive by taking a backup on the partition (which is configured while installing the software). During installation, you can define the amount of disk space to reserve for backups. The interface is easy and simple to use but there is no help provided in the main interface. Your only source of help is the manual which explains everything with screenshots. There are four modes of operation—two supervisor modes and two protection modes. Protection modes are the normal user modes, and all changes that are made to the file system, deletions, FDISK, etc, are ignored when the system is rebooted. You can make permanent changes to the drive only when you are in the supervisor mode. The

Price: Rs 3,490 (single user)
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software also lets you multi-boot the system, protects at least four hard drives or up to 10 logical drives on the PC, and lets the system be used by multiple users with individual settings. A value-for-money product that can eliminate almost all chances of data being mishandled or deleted from your machine.

SPECIFICATIONS:
1.14 MB installs size; available in PCI and parallel interface

HDD Sheriff 2000 B+	
Performance	★★★★1/2
Build Quality	★★★★1/2
Value for Money	★★★★
Features	★★★★1/2
OVERALL	★★★★1/2

Coffecup Firestarter 4.2

Coffee for a starter

Coffecup Firestarter 4.2 lets you create Flash effects that can be easily included in your Web page to make it more attractive. The built-in sound and GIF images make the task easy for the developer, especially newbies.

It generates HTML code for whatever you create, which can be viewed for verification. Strangely, though the Firestarter doesn't allow you to change the HTML code from within its notepad, it

allows copying the code into the Web page. After creating the effects, you can view it by just clicking on the test button.

With Coffecup, making splash screens becomes very easy using the built-in effects such as 'Explode' and 'Shrink'.



Firestarter even allows for converting WAV files to MP3s and GIF to Macromedia Flash (SWF) and uploading to the FTP. The download size of the trial version is 3.2 MB and the full version can be yours for \$49.

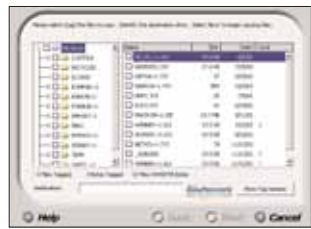
Price: Rs 2303 (approximately)
Web site: www.coffecup.com

SPECIFICATIONS:
3.2 MB download size; allows import of animated gif files; SWF files up to 80 per cent smaller in version 4.2

Coffecup Firestarter B+	
Performance	★★★★1/2
Ease of use	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★1/2
Features	★★★★
OVERALL	★★★★1/2

EasyRecovery Pro 5.0

Get it back



EasyRecovery is a data recovery solution from the world-renowned system utilities developer, Ontrack. It lets you recover files and data lost due to a hard drive or a system wide crash, power surges, etc. During the test, we purposely deleted randomly selected files. It took around 10 minutes to recover these files which were around 24 MB in size.

The interface resembles the system suite utility of

Ontrack. It runs on Windows 95/98/2000/ and NT and through the emergency boot disk feature, you can create emergency floppies so that the system doesn't boot in Windows and the files can still be recovered through DOS mode. EasyRecovery can also perform a comprehensive diagnostic test on your hard drive just like scandisk and it lets you know the status of your drive—whether or not the lost files can be recovered from the partition.

SPECIFICATIONS:
Can recover files and folder of all types; works with Windows 95/98/2000 and NT

Easy Recovery Pro 5 B	
Performance	★★★★1/2
Ease of use	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Features	★★★★1/2
OVERALL	★★★★

Price: \$489.00
Web site: www.ontrack.com

Panda Antivirus Software

Panda on guard

The Panda sports a more intuitive interface than other competing anti-virus suites. It also has the highest number of anti-virus definitions, which are updated almost on a daily basis. The user will have to use the specific user name and password to log on to the FTP server to download the definitions.

This software also has the facility of monitoring Inter-

net activity thereby giving you complete protection in the Internet age. You can even block certain ports so that your computer remains protected (like a firewall). Needless to mention, like all anti-virus products, even Panda has a heuristic scanner wherein the scanner can detect new viriuses on the basis of behaviour. It can also scan through e-mail